MAX MARCZINEK

Assistant Professor (tenure-track) in Economics
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Employment

University of Oslo, Department of Economics
Assistant Professor of International Trade *2026-*

Research Fields

Primary Field: International Trade
Secondary Fields: Growth, Economic History, Labour

Education

University of Oxford, Nuffield College
D.Phil. Economics, supervised by Banu Demir and Stephen Broadberry *2021-2026*
Humboldt University Berlin
Visiting PhD student, hosted by Gabriel Ahlfeldt *2025*
University of Oxford, Nuffield College
M.Phil. Economics – Distinction & George Webb Medley Prize *2019-2021*
Humboldt University Berlin
B.Sc. in Economics *2015-2019*
University of California, Los Angeles
Exchange Student, Economics *2017-2018*

Job Market Paper

Labour Scarcity, Capital Deepening, and Productivity: Insights from the Last Nordic Plague **New Version**

I study the causal impact of labour scarcity on productivity, a key driver of long-run growth. Exploiting a natural experiment, a 1710s plague outbreak, I show that labour-scarce plagued regions shift into capital-intensive goods and expand their exports. Using port-level trade data and a model of technology adoption, I trace the chain from labour scarcity through capital deepening to productivity growth. Parish-level production data confirm capital deepening and TFP growth. Technology adoption accounts for 51-75% of shifting comparative advantage, whose long-term change beyond population recovery is explained by adoption's sunk cost. Labour scarcity raises productivity where higher wages reach producers.

Finalist for the ***ECB Young Economist Prize 2026***
Winner of the ***FREIT-EIIT Award for Best Graduate Paper in Empirical Trade***
Winner of the ***GSWG & Stiftung für die Wissenschaft Best Paper Award Economic and Social History***

Publications

Networks in Trade – Evidence from the Legacy of the Hanseatic League (with Stephan Maurer and Ferdinand Rauch) (previously my Master's thesis) **Published Version**

Journal of International Economics, 2025

Working Papers

AI and Services-Led Growth: Evidence from Indian Job Adverts (with Alex Copestake, Ashley Pople, and Katherine Stapleton) **Working Paper, IMF Research Perspectives; Ideas for India, The Economist**

Revised and Resubmitted at ***Journal of Human Resources***

Selected Work in Progress

Industrial Policy and the East Asian Growth Miracle (with Nathan Lane and Kristen Yang)
Recipient of SSHRC Insight Grant (CAD $70,000) and CIDER Small Grant (CAD $24,851)

Automation Technology and Services Offshoring (with Marina Tavares and Kristen Yang)

Awards, Grants, and Scholarships

Finalist for the ECB Young Economist Prize
European Central Bank (ECB) *2026*
FREIT-EIIT Award for Best Graduate Paper in Empirical Trade
Forum for Research in International Trade (FREIT) *2025*
Best Paper Award Economic and Social History
German Economic History Association & Stiftung für die Wissenschaft *2025*
Add-On Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Science and Transfer (€15,000)
Joachim Herz Foundation *2025-2028*
Scatcherd Scholarship
University of Oxford *2025*
Department of Economics Bursary
University of Oxford *2023-2025*
SSHRC Insight Grant (CAD $70,000 with Réka Juhász and Nathan Lane)
Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council, Canada *2023*
Oxford-Terence Gorman Graduate Scholarship
University of Oxford *2021-2023*
CIDER Small Grant (CAD $24,851 with Réka Juhász and Nathan Lane)
Centre for Innovative Data in Economics Research, Canada *2022*
George Webb Medley Prize for the best thesis (proxime accessit)
University of Oxford *2021*
Clarendon Scholarship
University of Oxford *2019-2021*
Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes, Stipendiat
German Academic Scholarship Foundation, Scholar *2016-2021*
Henrike und Dr. Thomas Kurze Prize for best graduate in Economics
Humboldt University Berlin *2019*
Economics Undergraduate Research Fellow
University of California, Los Angeles *2017-2018*

Teaching

Department of Economics & Saïd Business School, University of Oxford
Micro- & Macroeconomics (TA, Graduate) *2021-2024*
International Trade Theory (TA, Graduate) *2024*
Department of Economics, Humboldt University, Berlin
Introduction to Econometrics (TA, Undergraduate) *2024, 2025*
Urban and Spatial Economics (TA, PhD) *2025*
Department of Economics & Department of History, University of Oxford
Economics for Economic Historians (Seminar Instructor, Graduate) *2021-2024*
New College & Mansfield College, University of Oxford
Microeconomics, Quantitative Economics (Tutor, Undergraduate) *2023, 2024*

Policy Work

Berlin Economics & GET
Consulted the Administration of the President of Uzbekistan on trade liberalisation *2025, 2026*
LSE Trade Policy Hub
Researcher on papers for the UK Department of Business and Trade *2023-2026*
LUISS Hub for New Industrial Policy and Economic Governance
Researcher for a White Book on Italian Productivity and Industrial Policy *2024-2025*

Service

Co-convenor of the Economic and Social History Graduate Seminar
University of Oxford *2021-2024*

JCR (College Student Body) President
Nuffield College, University of Oxford *2021-2023*

Conferences and Seminars

2025:
Empirical Investigations in International Trade (scheduled) (FREIT-EIIT, University of Tennessee),
Pandemics & Society Seminar (OsloMet University),
European Economic Association Meeting (University of Bordeaux),
Workshop on Technology and Long-Term Development (University of Valencia),
Urban Economics Association Conference (Humboldt University Berlin),
6th Congress for Economic and Social History (Humboldt University Berlin),
Economic and Social History of the Premodern World Seminar Series (Institute of Historical Research, London)

2024:
Empirical Investigations in Trade and Investment (EITI, Jakarta),
Annual Cliometric Conference (American University, Washington D.C.),
Spatial Economics Seminar (Berlin School of Economics),
Royal Economic Society Easter School (University of Bristol),
Urban Economics Association Summer School (University of Geneva)

2023:
European Economic Association Meeting (Barcelona School of Economics),
World Congress of Cliometrics (Trinity College Dublin),
Urban Economics Association Conference (Bocconi University),
Danish Society for Economic and Social History (Copenhagen Business School),
Transatlantic Doctoral Conference in Economics (London Business School),
GEP/CEPR Postgraduate Conference (University of Nottingham),
Economic and Social History Graduate Seminar (University of Oxford)

2022:
Urban Economics Association Conference (London School of Economics),
Economic and Social History Graduate Seminar (University of Oxford)

Languages and Skills

Languages: German (Native), English (Full professional proficiency), Dutch (Working proficiency), French (Working proficiency), Russian (Limited working proficiency), Italian (Limited working proficiency)
Skills: Stata, ArcGIS, LaTeX

References

Banu Demir
Professor at University of Oxford
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Réka Juhász
Professor at University of British Columbia
reka.juhasz@ubc.ca

Ferdinand Rauch
Professor at University of St. Gallen
ferdinand.rauch@unisg.ch

Stephen Broadberry
Professor at University of Oxford
stephen.broadberry@economics.ox.ac.uk